Community Engagement and Local Advocacy Survey

Survey results and strategic insights · 56 responses · 7 November 2026

67.9%
would use a mobile reporting app

76.8%
feel their voice has little to no impact

87.5%
open to joining or promoting a local group

67.9%
have never attended a meeting in person

Key takeaways

- **Overwhelming appetite for digital civic tech:** 67.9% (38 of 56) of respondents would use a mobile reporting app, with an additional 19.6% (11 of 56) expressing potential interest.
- **Deep disconnect in government responsiveness:** 76.8% (43 of 56) feel their voice has little to no impact on local officials (efficacy rating 1 or 2 out of 5), despite 66.7% (36 of 54) having actively raised issues with authorities.
- **Core infrastructure concerns:** Roads (64.3%), public safety (60.7%), water supply (51.8%), and sanitation (50.0%) are identified as the primary physical challenges facing the community.
- **High willingness to mobilize:** 87.5% (49 of 56) are open to joining or promoting a local community group (32.1% “Yes” and 55.4% “Maybe”), indicating strong latent advocacy potential.

What’s going well: latent community readiness and digital interest

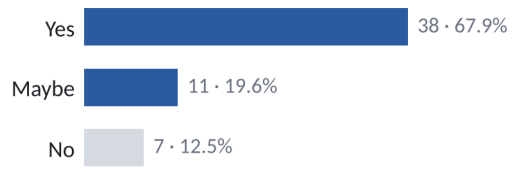
High efficacy demand for direct reporting channels

- **Unmet digital need:** While 48.2% (27 of 56) have never reported issues digitally and 21.4% (12 of 56) were unaware such tools existed, 67.9% (38 of 56) are eager to adopt a direct mobile reporting application.
- **Key adoption triggers:** Trust in a digital platform relies heavily on service level assurances: 74.1% (40 of 54) demand quick responses from authorities, while 61.1% (33 of 54) require real-time updates on complaint status.
- **Privacy controls:** Offering an option to report anonymously is critical for 44.4% (24 of 54) of prospective users.

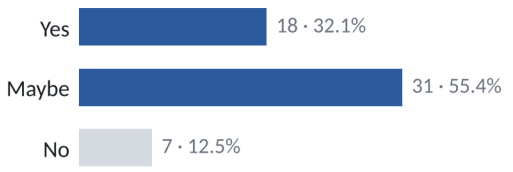
Proactive citizen participation potential

- **Community advocacy readiness:** 32.1% (18 of 56) are currently willing to join or promote a local community organization, while 55.4% (31 of 56) are open to doing so under the right conditions.
- **Active problem raising:** A majority (66.7%, 36 of 54) of citizens have taken the initiative to formally highlight local issues to public officials.

Would you use a mobile app to report problems?
56 responses



Would you join a community group, or promote it?
56 responses

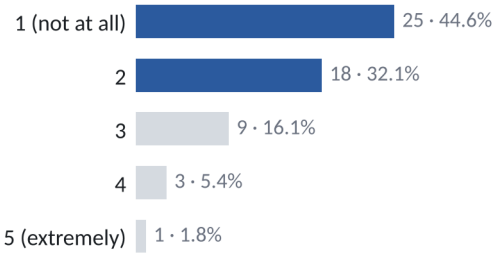


What's going wrong: structural barriers and communication breakdown

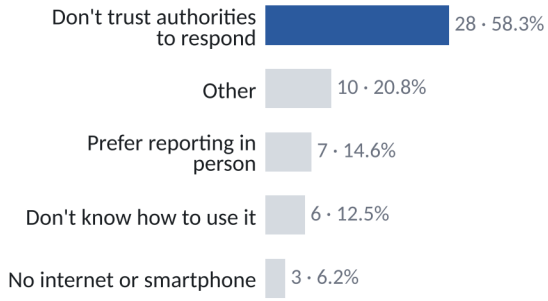
Trust breakdown in local leadership and follow-up mechanisms

- **Pessimism around official responsiveness:** 44.6% (25 of 56) feel their voice matters **not at all** (rating 1 of 5), and another 32.1% (18 of 56) rate efficacy at just 2 of 5.
- **Lack of resolution feedback:** Among those with access to local information channels, 37.0% (17 of 46) state there is no platform to track complaint status, and 23.9% (11 of 46) report that updates are not regularly provided.
- **Primary app hesitation:** 58.3% (28 of 48) of respondents who expressed doubts about using a civic app cited a **lack of trust that authorities would respond**.

Do you feel your voice matters to local officials?
56 responses



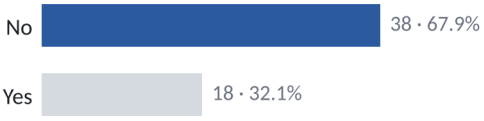
If you would not use the app, why not?
48 responses



Low in-person attendance driven by awareness deficits

- **In-person non-participation:** 67.9% (38 of 56) have never attended a community meeting or activity in person.
- **Participation bottlenecks:** The primary obstacles preventing active involvement are lack of time (42.6%, 23 of 54), lack of awareness (40.7%, 22 of 54), and the absence of organized groups (37.0%, 20 of 54).
- **Youth bias:** 74.5% (41 of 55) of respondents are aged 18–25, representing a digitally oriented demographic that requires modern engagement formats rather than traditional physical town halls.

Have you ever taken part in a community meeting in person?
56 responses



What stops you from participating?
54 responses

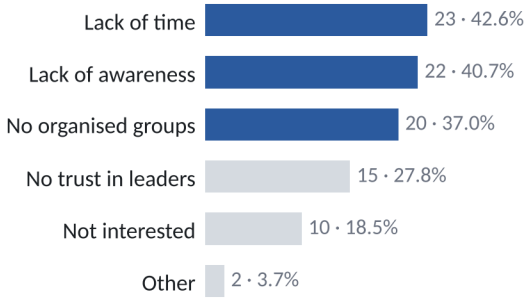
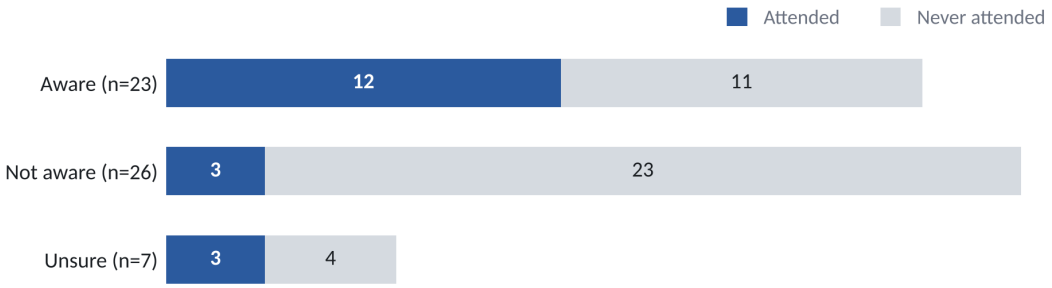


Chart insight: participation by group awareness

The chart demonstrates a direct relationship between organizational awareness and meeting attendance: **88.5%** of respondents who are unaware of local groups have never attended a community meeting, whereas **52.2%** of those who are aware actively participate in person.



Community friction points and priority solutions

CATEGORY	PRIMARY COMMUNITY PAIN POINTS	PREFERRED STRUCTURAL SOLUTIONS
Local infrastructure	Roads **64.3%** (36/56) Water supply **51.8%** (29/56) Sanitation and waste **50.0%** (28/56)	Stronger local committees **50.0%** (28/56) Direct government support **50.0%** (28/56)
Public services	Safety and security **60.7%** (34/56) Electricity **35.7%** (20/56)	WhatsApp and social media groups **41.1%** (23/56) Regular community meetings **39.3%** (22/56)
Social capacity	Lack of organized neighborhood groups **37.0%** (20/54) No trust in leaders **27.8%** (15/54)	Advocacy training **23.2%** (13/56) Partnerships with NGOs **17.9%** (10/56)

Actionable recommendations

01 **Implement real-time ticket tracking**

Require all civic reporting systems to feature automated status updates and estimated resolution times to directly address the **58.3%** distrust barrier.

02 **Launch multi-channel social hubs**

Establish official WhatsApp and social media groups to reach the **41.1%** requesting digital coordination and accommodate the **74.5%** youth population.

03 **Enable anonymous reporting**

Incorporate privacy-first submission features and photo uploading capabilities to boost submission volume and security.

04 **Formalize neighborhood committees**

Partner with local leaders to build structured committees (**50.0%** priority) that bridge the gap between residents and official authorities.

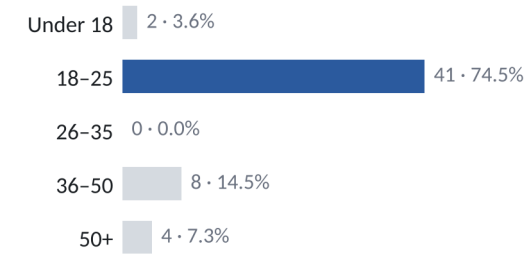
Note on the sample: with 56 responses and 74.5% aged 18–25, results reflect a young, digitally oriented group and should not be read as representative of the whole community. Percentages use the number of people who answered each question, which varies from 46 to 56.

Appendix: full survey results

Highlighted bars mark the leading responses for each question.

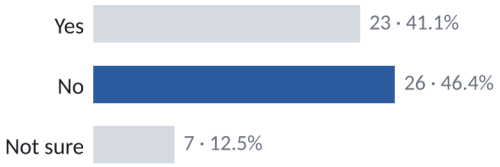
1. What is your age group?

55 responses



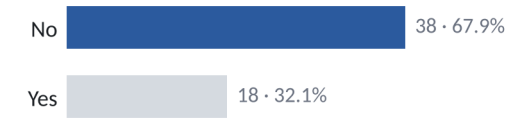
2. Are you aware of any community groups, NGOs, or committees in your area?

56 responses



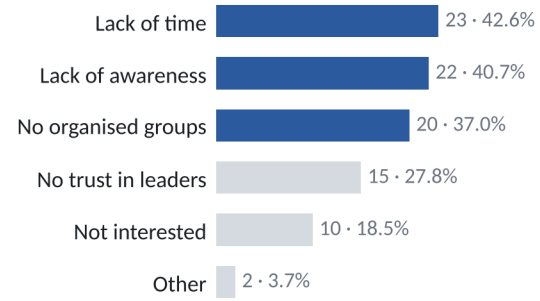
3. Have you ever taken part in a community meeting or activity in person?

56 responses



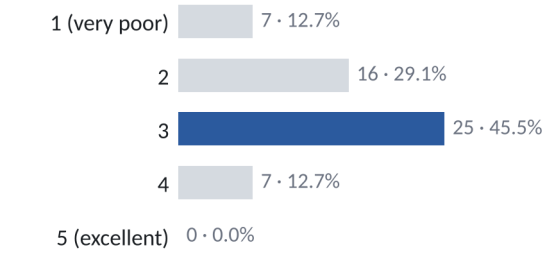
4. What stops you from participating?

54 responses



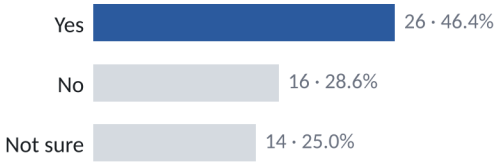
5. How would you rate coordination among people and groups in your community?

55 responses



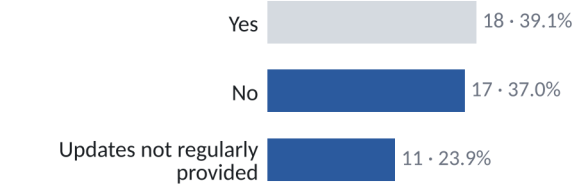
6. Is there a clear way to share information about local issues?

56 responses



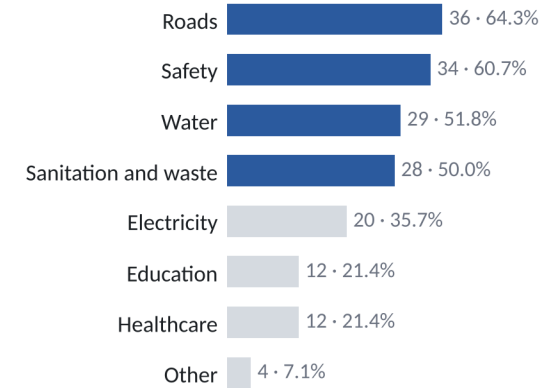
7. (If yes) Is there a platform to receive follow-ups or track updates on reported problems?

46 responses

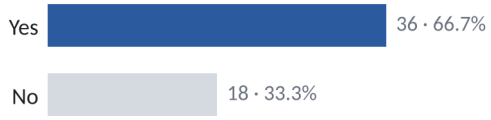


8. What are the biggest problems in your area?

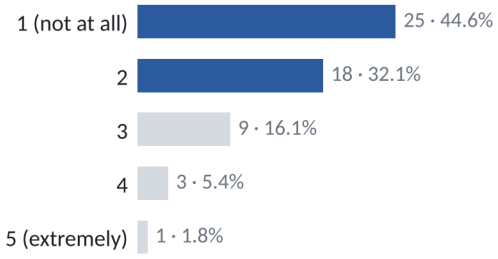
56 responses



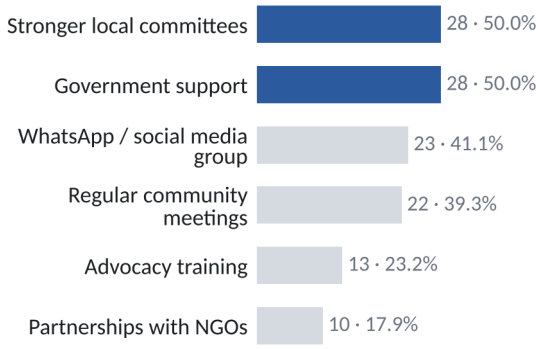
9. Have you or your community ever raised these issues with authorities?
54 responses



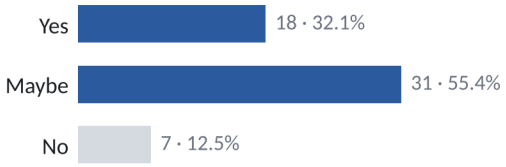
10. Do you feel your voice matters to local officials or representatives?
56 responses



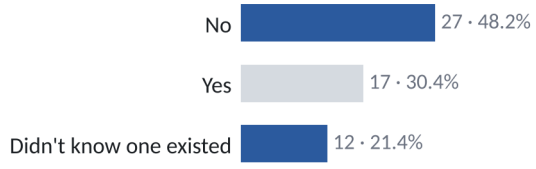
11. Which of these would improve coordination and advocacy most?
56 responses



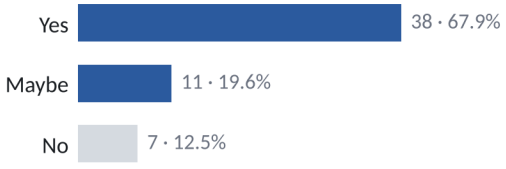
12. Would you be willing to join a community group, or at least promote it?
56 responses



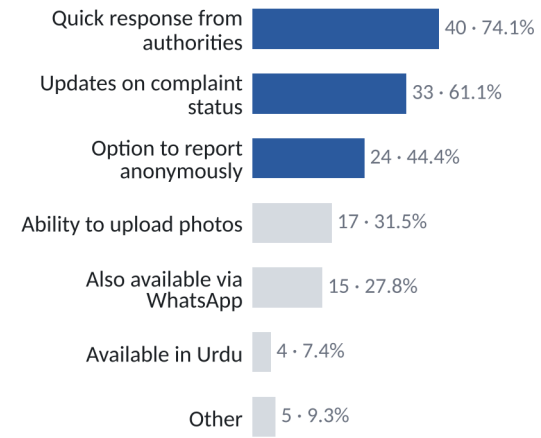
13. Have you ever used a website, app, or helpline to report a local problem?
56 responses



14. Would you use a mobile app that lets you report problems directly to authorities?
56 responses



15. What would make you trust and use such an app?
54 responses



16. If you would not use it, why not?
48 responses

